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TEMPERAMENT, TRUTH AND LEADERSHIP

I'VE BEEN hearing it for years. I've been blamed for it often. I'm rebuked for my shot selection because of it. I'm chastised for my locker-room behaviour because of it. When I show a seriousness of intent, I attract sniggers because of it.

It's the ghost that's always in the attic. It's the elephant in the room. It's my 'temperament problem'.

Even though my friends are kind and say that I've changed the game due to my temperament, I realize I am an emotional man. Back in the day, I was more emotional than I am now. I've made mistakes because emotions got in the way of rational thinking. It now reminds me of the old Pashto saying: 'Don't make promises when you are happy. Don't take decisions when you are angry.'

Today, I wish I'd paid heed to such wisdom. Perhaps it would have made me a better player or a better person.

Everyone makes mistakes. But when you make a mistake, the most important thing, first and foremost, is to accept it and assess what went wrong. Then, you must fix yourself pronto. Time adds value to maturity. Let it come. Such maturity comes early to some. For us Pathans, however, maybe it takes longer. I think it has come to me, finally. I sure as hell hope so.

But the truth must be told. Under all and any circumstances. The truth needs backing. The truth needs support. There's not enough truth in the world. The truth needs to be upheld. Maybe this is easier said than done because I've always taken pride – sometimes foolishly – in not being a yes-man. I must admit, even push, that the truth must be told. Always.

There are people out there who take U-turns. Some take them for a living. Politicians, for example. Usually, one can catch them performing their little magic tricks of deceit just by their facial expressions, be it in a private meeting or at a press conference. You can even tell if they are